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TAB 28



Board of Education Report

File #: Res-045-25/26, **Version:** 1

Agenda Date: 3/10/2026

In Control: Board of Education

Ms. Gonez, Mr. Yang, Mr. Melvoin, Ms. Ortiz Franklin - Power to the Youth: Supporting Youth Voting in Los Angeles (Res-045-25/26) (Waiver of Board Rule 72)

Whereas, The Los Angeles City Charter outlines the framework for the elections and governance for the City of Los Angeles and the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District;

Whereas, Los Angeles City leadership approved the formation of the Los Angeles Charter Commission in 2024, a volunteer citizens panel to make recommendations on reforms by April 2026 to the City Council, who will then consider placing those reforms before voters on the November 2026 ballot;

Whereas, Among other issues being reviewed, the Commission is considering whether the voting age for elections for City and Board of Education elections should be changed from 18 years to 16 years;

Whereas, In 2019 in Res-030-18/19, "Supporting Expanding Voting Rights to 16 Years and Older for Los Angeles Unified School District Board Member Elections," authored by its then-Student Board Member, the Board unanimously affirmed its support for pursuing a lower voting age;

Whereas, The resolution, "LAUSD V.O.T.E.S. (Voting Opportunities That Empower Students)" (Res-013-25/26), authored by the current Student Board Member and passed earlier this school year, underscored the importance of student voting, including for the Student Board Member position, and identified new strategies to promote civic participation and voter registration;

Whereas, Students have a vested interest in the leadership over LAUSD schools and are uniquely positioned to identify what is and isn't working in the public education system;

Whereas, Students aged 16 and 17 now vote in Oakland and Berkeley school board elections after voters-approved ballot measures, demonstrating both the feasibility and viability of the lower voting age;

Whereas, The current political moment only heightens the need for and impact of student voice, with students participating in walkouts and other instances of civic activism in defense of their communities and their values; and

Whereas, Youth voting would ensure that students' unique perspective helps shape Board leadership and make representatives more responsive to the student experience; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District reaffirms its support for voting at 16 years and older for local elections, including LAUSD Board elections, City of Los Angeles elections, and elections in cities throughout LAUSD boundaries; and be it finally,

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Resolved, That the District will advocate for the lower voting age with the Los Angeles Charter Reform Commission and City Council and for its inclusion in the forthcoming anticipated ballot initiative reforming the Los Angeles City Charter in November 2026.